

boss asks you to do something stupid? Most people are going to say yes. Doing otherwise could put everything you have at risk. Jeremy observed that having the confidence to say, “I don’t think that’s the best way to do it, and this is how I think we should go forward” changes an employer’s perspective of you.

Having the freedom and confidence to not go with the flow enables you to take risks that will add value to an organization. Suddenly, instead of being another pushover, you’re seen as a go-getter. The power dynamic shifts when you’re not reliant on your employer to provide a paycheck for your survival. The worst-case scenario is you getting fired. If you don’t rely on that next paycheck to stave off disaster, the scenario is not so scary.

F-you money is a powerful concept that many in the FI community have latched on to. But it’s vague. We all quantify the exact amount we need based on our individual personalities, attitudes toward money, and risk tolerance.

We need a better framework with which to quantify the stages and benchmarks along the path to FI as we track our progress and celebrate small wins along the way. Joel, who with his wife Alexis, writes the blog *Financial 180*, discussed this at length with Brad and